

Meagan McKeever

Senior Food Scientist and AI/ML Developer

Baarn, Utrecht, Netherlands · +31 6 25110533 · mckeever.meagan@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/meaganmmckeever

01 / PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Samyang Foods — Food Technology Application Scientist

WAGENINGEN, NETHERLANDS

AUGUST 2025–PRESENT

- Direct Samyang's Digital R&D program: a 4-year, €4.5M roadmap reaching 7 FTE by 2030 — AI-ready IT transformation, enterprise AI tools, and embedded agents fine-tuned for scientific workflows.
- Developed and launched a production enterprise application for optimization of protein quality, satiety factors, and nutrition claims; assists developers with formulation and regulatory readiness; UI and headless service serve 6–10 concurrent internal users.
- Built a fully local RAG and HyperGraphRAG enterprise system for ingredient, formula, and experiment data, feeding every internal application and tool.
- Built the structured data pipeline (ELN and hypergraph retrieval), manage analytical data acquisition, and develop machine-learning models predicting properties such as taste and texture, positioning the laboratory to adopt robotics by 2030.
- Work across European and Korean stakeholders, helping translate technical context, project priorities, and application evidence between teams.
- Develop and evaluate plant-based, protein-forward, and savory application concepts, considering ingredient functionality, texture, spreadability, flavor delivery, nutritional targets, process feasibility, and cost.

Unilever Food Solutions — Lead Process Technologist

WAGENINGEN, NETHERLANDS

MAY 2024–AUGUST 2025

- Developed ML models and CFD simulations for heat transfer and microbiological safety of product through steam-injection UHT, including sufficient thermal processing of frozen commercial meal products by end users.
- Validated third-party manufacturers by building a digital twin of the production line, modeling the flow behavior of product and formula, and modeling the physical and chemical changes during processing to optimize flavor notes — removal of undesirable and retention of desirable.
- Managed a Bacillus cereus non-conforming product from a pilot trial: traced sample distribution, successfully recalled 100% of units for destruction, investigated and determined root cause, and implemented a third-party-manufacturer pre-trial qualification standard for the UFS division.
- Led the process technology forum for company-wide presentation of processing innovation and projects where AI and other emerging technologies were used to solve problems or improve products and operations.

innocent drinks — Senior Process Technologist

ROTTERDAM, NETHERLANDS

SEPTEMBER 2022–NOVEMBER 2023

- Senior processing expert for the Blender, a novel net-zero-emissions food factory: SCADA commissioning, HMI implementation, PID tuning, automation engineering, and systems integration.
- Reduced batch time 75% (six hours to 1.5) applying SMED and Kaizen; increased blended production volume 260%; qualified all 16 recipes for a major insourcing and process-transfer program; led CAPEX and automation initiatives from requirements through commissioning across a 20-project portfolio.

FUL Foods — Lead Product Developer

DELFT, NETHERLANDS

AUGUST 2021–SEPTEMBER 2022

- Managed the laboratory team and a 12-month spirulina reformulation program: tripled shelf life, qualified products for room-temperature storage, raised consumer acceptability from 3/9 to 7/9, and delivered the technical improvements that secured a multinational retail customer.
- Introduced a stage-gate NPD process and led formulation, pilot trials, scale-up, and technical transfer in a fast-moving scale-up environment.

Rip Van Wafels — R&D Manager

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK, USA

JANUARY 2020–FEBRUARY 2021

- Led R&D for a \$12 million stroopwafel brand: launched five SKUs contributing \$2 million in revenue growth in one year.
- Technical lead and CAPEX support for a new production site — equipment decisions, process requirements, commissioning, and manufacturing readiness — while strengthening ISO 22000, SQF, and GFSI-aligned quality systems.

Tazzy Candy Corp. — Co-Founder and Product Developer

BROOKLYN, NEW YORK, USA

2019

- Co-founded a low-sugar, clean-label confectionery business; led product from concept through formulation and launch preparation.

B&G Foods — Senior Food Scientist

PARSIPPANY, NEW JERSEY, USA

NOVEMBER 2017–JANUARY 2020

- Post-acquisition technical integration of the Back to Nature portfolio into B&G Foods, spanning brands, products, systems, manufacturers, and technical requirements.
- Created a new product and manufacturing platform worth approximately \$13 million annualized; cut manufacturing cost 50% and delivered approximately \$1 million in annual raw-material savings; transferred an \$8 million cookie line to a new manufacturer through commissioning and start-up.
- Repositioned Back to Nature as a plant-based-snacks brand through reformulation of 88 SKUs.

Back to Nature Foods — Senior Food Scientist

NAPLES, FLORIDA, USA

MAY 2016–NOVEMBER 2017

- Held R&D, Quality, Regulatory, and Consumer Affairs responsibility for a \$120 million portfolio (Back to Nature, SnackWell's); commercialized 12 products and supported 18 launches across 2016–2017.
- Supported the acquisition and integration work through the \$162.5 million sale of Back to Nature Foods to B&G Foods (completed October 2017), maintaining continuity across active product and quality priorities.
- Maintained 100+ finished-product specifications and technical relationships across 22 co-packer locations; led quality audits, CAPA, and technical investigations.

Covance / Eurofins — Associate Food Scientist

NAPLES, FLORIDA, USA

AUGUST 2014–MAY 2016

- Contract product development across bakery, confectionery, supplements, and nutrition bars: pilot-scale prototypes, analytical testing, stability studies, and sensory programs through commercialization.
- Managed the Non-GMO Project certification program for 86 SKUs in five months, including 36 reformulations, coordinating 22 co-packers and 100+ ingredient suppliers.

02 / EDUCATION AND DISTINCTION

Cornell University — Bachelor of Science, Food Science

ITHACA, NEW YORK, USA

2010–2014

Undergraduate research: fish-gelatin applications for confectionery (rheology, functional performance).

Co-inventor — Hydrocolloid Stabilized Dehydrated Food Foam, WO2012112700A2 (Cornell).

First Place, IFTSA/Disney Product Development Competition 2014 (team leader) · **First Place**, IFTSA/Mars 2012.

03 / DATA AND DIGITAL

Minitab; Power BI; structured data; TypeScript; React; Next.js; Python; SQL; Supabase; Postgres; Vercel; faster-whisper; pyannote; FAISS; RAG; graph and hypergraph retrieval; semantic clustering; acoustic analysis; agent workflows; n8n; QLoRA; local inference; automated testing; evidence provenance.

04 / LANGUAGES AND CERTIFICATION

English — native.

Dutch — B1, working/conversational.

Lean Six Sigma — trained.